

Hiring Assistant

LinkedIn Talent Solutions India on humanising AI recruitment

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For anyone currently navigating the job market, the application process can feel like shouting into a digital void. There is a growing fear that your resume, the document you've meticulously polished to represent your life's work, isn't even being seen by a human being. Instead, many candidates worry they are being ghosted by a cold, unfeeling "black box" algorithm that lacks basic human logic and discards talent based on a missing keyword.

However, according to Nithya Rajagopalan, Director of Engineering at LinkedIn Talent Solutions India, the reality of the engineering behind these tools is far more collaborative than most people think. During a recent interview with Digit, Rajagopalan explained that the goal isn't to automate humans out of the loop, but to architect a bridge of trust between machine efficiency and human intuition. As the technical lead for LinkedIn's Hiring Assistant, she is steering a shift toward "systems thinking" where AI acts as a partner rather than an autonomous gatekeeper.

Dismantling recruiter myths

The biggest hurdle for AI in recruitment isn't just the code; it's the trust gap. Rajagopalan is quick to point out that the industry needs to move past the idea that AI is a lone decision-maker. "It's something that people say, AI will make a decision and then we just have to go along with it," she notes. "That's not true". In LinkedIn's architecture, "AI is helping you to

come up with a list and then the final decision is taken by the end recruiter".

Another major misconception is that these advanced tools are reserved solely for tech giants. Rajagopalan explains that LinkedIn has engineered products like Hiring Pro that work really well for smaller businesses as well, "where they can use AI for online applications". For those worried about a process where they have no idea why the AI has made a certain choice, she is blunt: "That's not the case. You can bring in explainability. You can bring in responsible AI. It's all about the investments on the AI engineering side".

The architecture of "High potential" signals

So, how does the system actually figure out who is a "high-potential" candidate in a market as massive and noisy as India? It comes down to the volume and speed of feedback. Rajagopalan explains that "if there are like too many signals, which are very similar, immediately the AI can pick up and say, okay, among all of these signals that we are getting, this is a higher potential".

The system is designed to be incredibly responsive. "Sometimes the reasoning can be within an hour, sometimes the learning can be within an hour, sometimes a day," she says. But it's not just about speed; it's

about accuracy. If only one recruiter is providing a signal, the AI doesn't just jump to conclusions because "it is not a very high signal for the AI to learn from". The goal is to ensure the system learns from a "mass of feedback" rather than over-optimizing for a single person's bias.

Engineering explainability into the workflow

The most critical part of the Hiring Assistant is that it is designed to show its work to the human user. "When it suggests a candidate," Rajagopalan said, "it doesn't just say, here are

my 20 candidates. It shows why it is recommending those 20 candidates. It identifies exactly which qualifications match the job and even tells where it got that information".

This means a recruiter sees a "checkmark or a cross on what it is mapping or not mapping" for a specific role. The system will explicitly tell the recruiter if it "read that from LinkedIn's profile" or "from the resume". This gives the human recruiter "clear evidences and proof points as to why it has made that decision," allowing them to validate the logic rather than following it blindly.

This transparency also helps solve for semantic adjacency – the idea that a candidate might have the right skills even if they didn't use the exact keywords a recruiter is searching for. "By giving recruiters a user interface where they can actually go and modify, you can review, you can edit, you can delete," the AI keeps learning from those human adjustments to refine the role requirements. **d**



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